

Jasmine Banks

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Psychology, Certificate in Digital Studies	Expected Spring 2027
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI	
Dissertation: "<i>Black Digital Lifeworlds: A Mixed Methods Approach to Exploring the Psychological Impacts of Identity, Culture, Technology, and Well-being</i>" Advisors: Isis Settles, L. Monique Ward	
M.S. in Psychology	2023
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI	
B.A. in Psychology, Minor in Sociology	2019
Florida International University, Miami, Florida	

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Black Digital culture
- Meaning-making and well-being
- AI Ethics & Sociotechnical Governance
- Online Dating
- Human–Technology Relations

AWARDS & GRANTS

Awards

- 2026 Jay and Kay Peters Graduate Psychology Student Award, University of Michigan | Recognized for outstanding research promise and scholarly achievement in psychology.
- 2024 Department of Psychology Diversity Teaching Award, University of Michigan | For significant contributions towards advancing diversity in teaching
- 2024 Research University Alliance Visiting Scholars Program, University of Michigan | A program to advance PhD scholar for a cross-university program fostering mentorship, professional development, and inclusive research excellence across STEM.
- 2023 Jay and Kay Peters Graduate Psychology Student Award, University of Michigan | Recognized for outstanding research promise and scholarly achievement in psychology.
- 2023 Nan Donald Award for Interdisciplinary Study in Psychology and Sociology, University of Michigan | Supports and encourages continuing interdisciplinary study in Psychology and Sociology
- 2023 Summer Writing Grant (UMDSI), University of Michigan | Support for advancing writing over the summer.
- 2020 Rackham Merit Fellowship, University of Michigan | fellowship supporting academic excellence, diversity, and inclusion by recognizing graduate students with outstanding potential and diverse experiences.
- 2019 Elaine Gordon Scholarship, Florida International University | Awarded to Women’s and Gender Studies students demonstrating academic excellence and commitment to advancing women’s rights and equality.

2018 McNair Scholar, Florida International University | Federally funded initiative that prepares underrepresented and first-generation undergraduates for doctoral study through mentored research and professional development.

Grants

- 2025** Digital Studies Graduate Research Grant, University of Michigan | Award for the purpose of supporting the development of a digital scholarship project with UM Library
- 2025** PACE Fellowship, University of Michigan | Recognizes doctoral students and faculty mentors for scholarly excellence and commitment to improving program climate, student success, and community building.
- 2024** Digital Studies Institute Graduate Student Research Grant, University of Michigan | seed funding to convene cross-disciplinary, intergenerational teams advancing technology-and-social-justice research through labs, reading groups, and workshops.
- 2024** Digital IDEAS Summer Institute Grant, University of Michigan | Supports innovative, interdisciplinary projects that advance critical research at the intersections of technology, culture, and society.
- 2023** Mellon Public Engagement and the Humanities Grant, University of Michigan | Support for training in public scholarship, equipping graduate students to apply research to collaborative, community-facing projects.
- 2022** National Center for Institutional Diversity Grant, University of Michigan | Supports graduate scholars advancing diversity, equity, and inclusion through interdisciplinary research, public scholarship, and community engagement.
- 2021** UM Mini Library Grant, University of Michigan | Provides funding for innovative student research and projects that make creative use of library collections, services, and expertise.
- 2021** Rackham Summer Internship, University of Michigan | — Provides advanced doctoral students with mentored, career-development internships that integrate academic training with professional experience beyond the academy.
- 2019** Braman Scholars Completion Grant, Florida International University | Supports final-year students at FIU in completing their degrees through need-based financial assistance.
- 2019** NSF Sociology Summer Research Fellow, Texas A&M University | Funded summer program providing undergraduates with mentored, hands-on research training in sociology and the social sciences.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- Williams, A., Brathwaite, K., **Banks, J.**, Monier, M., Benson, E., Saylor, J. W., & Paredes, G. (2026). Needs Translation: Advocating for Marginalized Communities in Tech Design. In *Proceedings of the 59th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences* (pp. 1864–1868). <https://doi.org/10.24251/HICSS.2026.222>
- **Banks, J.**, Monier, M., & Samuel, A. (2025). What's algorithms got to do with it? Exploring Black women's pursuit of Black love on dating apps. *Discourse, Context & Media*, 65. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.dcm.2024.100871>
- **Banks, J.**, Monier, M., Reynaga, M., & Williams, A. (2024). From the auction block to the Tinder swipe: Black women's experiences with fetishization on dating apps. *New Media & Society*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448241235904>
- **Banks, J.**, & Ward, M. (2024). From Microaggressions to Viral Trends: A Qualitative Examination of Black Emerging Adults' Experiences with Online Racial Discrimination. *Emerging Adulthood*

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- From, A., **Banks, J.**, & Edelstein, R. S. (2024). Partner support behaviors and relationship quality in interracial and intraracial Black romantic relationships. *Personal Relationships*, 31(3), 796-815.
- **Banks, J.**, (2023) The Error, The Glitch, And the Margin: Sites Of Radical Possibility. *Journal Of Interactive Technology and Pedagogy*.
- Thomas, Z., **Banks, J.**, Eaton, A., Ward, L. (2022). 25 years of Psychology Research on the ‘Strong Black Woman. *Social and Personality Psychology Compass*.
- Perkins, T., Durkee, M., **Banks, J.**, Ribero-Brown, B.(2021). Gender and Racial Identity Moderate the Effects of Online and Offline Discrimination on Mental Health. *Journal of Research on Adolescence*.
- Ruvalcaba, Y., & Eaton, A., Stephens, D., & **Banks, J.** (2020) A culture of care: How Lotus House Women’s Shelter heals program participants through genuineness, dignity, belonging, individualized attention, high expectations, and space. *Journal of Community Psychology*.

Book Chapters

- **Banks, J.**, & Saunders, J. F. (2025). Mental health in graduate school. A. Eaton, *Navigating your Ph.D.: Challenges and strategies for thriving* (1st ed., Chapter 2). Routledge.
- **Banks, J.**, Harrison, E., Seth, P. (2026). If You Know, You Know: Black Digital Culture and the Right to Opacity. *Black Identities in Media*. LSU Press.
- **Banks, J.**, & Monier, M. (2025). Sexting. In E. E. Blair & S. L. Sherry (Eds.), *The SAGE Encyclopedia of Education and Gender (Forthcoming)*. SAGE Publications.
- Ward, L. M., **Banks, J.**, Bridgewater, E., & Reynaga, M. (2024). Social identity. In E. Scharrer (Ed.), *Children, media, and technology: Access, equity, diversity, and inclusion* (pp. 119-142). Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003453123-9>

Public Scholarship

- **Banks, J.**, Monier, M., & Stowell, O. (2023) Time to Be Real? Nostalgia, Authenticity, And the Digital Return to The Everyday. *Flo*. <https://www.flojournal.org/2023/02/be-real-nostalgia-authenticity-digital/>

Under review

- **Banks, J.** (under review). When Users Lead: Toward User-Centered Epistemologies in Platform Research
- **Banks, J.**, & Benson, E., Abrons, E., Bui., Halegoua, G. R., Hu, T., & Williams, A. (under review). Toward reparative AI: Insights from a review of AI ethics frameworks & philosophies.
- Monier, M., **Banks, J.**, Sayler, J. W., Benson, E., Brathwaite, K., Williams, A. (under review). “It’s giving fast food.” Black Women’s Logics of Dating Apps. *Journal of Black Sexuality and Relationships*.

In Preparation

- **Banks, J.** What is the ‘Black’ in Black Digital Culture?
- Sayler, J. W., **Banks, J.**, From, A. From Ideology to Intimacy: Politics and Race in Online Dating

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Fellow

University of Michigan -- ClimbsUp | January 2026 – Present

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Graduate Student Researcher

University of Michigan – Humanities Collaboratory | May 2024 – Present

- Conduct literature reviews and contribute to interdisciplinary research on the philosophical foundations and ethical implications of technology, focusing on artificial intelligence (AI)
- Research and write peer-reviewed articles and public-facing works on AI frameworks and epistemology, emphasizing the concept of reparative AI
- Engage with critical discussions on the ethical and societal impacts of AI, fostering a deeper understanding of technology's role in addressing inequities

Graduate Research Fellow

University of Michigan – DISCO Network | August 2023 – August 2024

- Collaborate with DISCO Network co-PIs Dr. Lisa Nakamura and Dr. Andre Brock on interdisciplinary projects examining digital culture, inequities, and critical technocultural discourse

Graduate Research Fellow

University of Michigan – Center for Racial Justice | August 2023 – Present

- Co-founded *Decolonial Dialogues: A Workshop for Resistant Knowledge Production*, a graduate student-led initiative fostering liberation-centered scholarship and praxis
- Designed and facilitated workshops to cultivate intersectional approaches to liberation by synthesizing resistant knowledge created by oppressed communities
- Built a collaborative "home base" for graduate students whose research prioritizes anti-oppression and the liberation of marginalized populations

Graduate Researcher

University of Michigan | August 2020 – Present

- **Multiple Intersecting Identities (Mii) Lab** (Advisor: Dr. Isis Settles)
 - Conducted research examining the mental health impacts of online directed and vicarious racial discrimination on Black youth. Manuscript in preparation for publication
- **Ward Lab** (Advisor: Dr. L. Monique Ward)
 - *NCID-Funded Project*: Conducted one-on-one interviews for “Black Women’s Online Dating Experience” to explore safety strategies, stereotypes, and experiences of Black women in online dating
 - *UM Mini Library Grant Project*: Designed and conducted 5 in-depth focus groups for “An Exploration of Black Culture, Identity, and Affect in the Digital Space,” investigating perceptions of Black digital culture, its role in identity and digital production, and its connection to deeper Black traditions and ideologies
- **The Bodies, Identities, Intimacies, and Technologies (BIIT) Lab** (Advisor: Dr. Apryl Williams)
 - Conducted research on the intersections of identity, intimacy, and technology, examining how digital platforms shape embodied experiences and social relationships

Researcher – Protecting the Privacy of Users of Identity-Based Social Media Groups

Florida International University in partnership with Facebook | 2022–2023

- Served as a qualitative researcher on a Facebook-funded mixed-methods project examining privacy tools for identity-based social media groups
- Recruited and curated Facebook groups for study inclusion based on identity-based community structures
- Conducted and analyzed semi-structured interviews with Facebook group administrators regarding platform affordances, privacy needs, and online harassment threats
- Co-developed coding frameworks using constant comparative method; led qualitative analysis for pattern identification and user needs synthesis
- Co-authored public-facing white papers for technology stakeholders and peer-reviewed manuscripts for academic dissemination
- Presented findings internally to technology partners and externally at academic conferences

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Workshop Lead and Research Educator

Stanford Athletics | *April, 2026*

Beyond the Game: Social Media, Identity and Mental Health.

- Facilitated a workshop for student-athletes and coaches on how social media affects mental health, identity, relationships, and performance
- Taught the psychological and physiological mechanisms underpinning platform engagement, including cortisol response, reward loops, and gambling logics in feed design
- Translated research on visibility, online feedback, and identity stress into practical techniques for emotional regulation, digital boundaries, and healthier digital engagement

Consultant

Feeld Dating App | *May 2025 – February 2026*

- Developed an app-wide self-discovery tool grounded in psychological science to support user exploration of attachment styles, sexual preferences, safer sex practices, relationship boundaries, red flags, and interpersonal communication
- Developed a series of three surveys based on existing literature for the self-discovery tool
- Led four focus groups during the testing phase with 20 participants
- Presented findings and wrote research reports on the development process for stakeholders and partners

Digital Studies Institute (DSI) Rackham Interdisciplinary Workshop Facilitator

University of Michigan – DSI | *August 2024– Present*

- Successfully managed a \$5,000 grant from the Rackham Graduate School to develop and sustain interdisciplinary programming for graduate students
- Organized and facilitated academic workshops, reading groups, and public-facing events
- Oversaw budget allocation, book purchasing, and financial reporting, ensuring proper stewardship of university funds
- Strengthened interdisciplinary collaboration through event design, resource curation, and continuous engagement with graduate participants

Graduate Student Staff Assistant

University of Michigan – Public Scholarship Office | *August 2022 – May 2023*

- Managed fellowship and scholarship databases, ensuring accurate data entry and streamlined organization

- Conducted data analysis and management for multiple ongoing projects, contributing to informed decision-making processes
- Performed UX (User Experience) and UI (User Interface) design and research, analyzing website interface usability, needs, and design improvements
- Reviewed fellowship and grant applications for Ph.D. and master's students, providing critical evaluations for public scholarship grant funding

TEACHING & MENTORING

Graduate Student Mentor

University of Michigan – Black Undergraduate Psychological Association | August 2024 - present

- Provided mentorship to undergraduate students

Instructor of Record

University of Michigan – Psychology of the Black Digital Experience(s) | *September 2023 – December 2023*

- Designed and developed an undergraduate seminar exploring the psychology of Black digital experiences, with 15 enrolled students
- Created course materials, assignments, and exams, and facilitated twice-weekly lectures
- Led discussions, graded assignments, and provided one-on-one mentoring and support during office hours
- Supported students' academic and professional growth through personalized guidance beyond the classroom

Graduate Student Instructor

University of Michigan – Psychology Department | *January 2021 – May 2023*

- Taught courses including *Introduction to Personality Psychology (Psych 290)* and *Introduction to Developmental Psychology*
- Led three discussion sections per course (75 students total), prepared teaching materials, and facilitated active learning through engaging discussions
- Graded assignments, exams, and papers, and provided individualized feedback to enhance students' learning experiences

Academic Mentor – Academic Success Program

University of Michigan – Athletics Department | *August 2022 – May 2023*

- Mentored first-year student-athletes to develop academic skills and strategies for success
- Provided personalized academic guidance, monitored performance, and fostered time management and study habits

PROFESSIONAL CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **Banks, J.** (August 2025). What Does Psychology Contribute to the Technological Zeitgeist? Presentation at the American psychological Association in Denver, Colorado
- Sayler, J. W., **Banks, J.**, From, A. (2025, June). From Ideology to Intimacy: Politics and Race in Online Dating. Poster presented at the Society for the Psychological Study of Social Issues. Portland, OR.
- Monier, M., **Banks, J.**, Sayler, J. W., Benson, E., Brathwaite, K., Williams, A. (2025, March). 'It's giving fast food:' Black Women's Perceptions of Dating App Platforms and Algorithms. Poster presented at the Black Graduate Research Studies Conference, Ann Arbor, MI.

- **Banks, J.** (November 2024). A Critical Reflection of the Walk-Through Method for Online Dating Research. Presentation at the National Communications Association in New Orleans
- **Banks, J.** (August 2023). Black Life. Presentation at the American Psychological Association in Washington DC.
- **Banks, J.** (November 2022). Black (Student) Athlete Cybercultures Roundtable Session. At the North American Society for the Sociology of Sport in Las Vegas, Nevada.
- **Banks, J.** (October 2022). A Qualitative Exploration of Black Culture, Identity and Affect in the Digital Sphere. Brownbag Presentation at the Personality and Social Context area Brownbag, Ann Arbor, Michigan.
- **Banks, J.** (2022, October). *A qualitative exploration of Black culture, identity, and affect in the digital sphere* [Brownbag presentation]. Personality and Social Context Area Brownbag, Ann Arbor, MI.
- Throne, K., **Banks, J.**, & Harrison, E. A. (2022, (June)., 2022). A #BlackInTheIvory: Black scholars using Scholars Using Twitter as a digital counterspace [Digital Counterspace. Interactive discussion]. Society for the Psychological Study of Social Issues, San Juan, Puerto Rico.
- **Banks, J.** (2022, A. (May). *A thematic analysis of online racial discrimination* [, 2022). Thematic Analysis of Online Racial Discrimination. Paper presentation]. International Communication Association, Paris, France.
- **Banks, J.**, Barron, V., Paez-Arellano, M., & Sell, J. (Summer, 2021, August). *Modifying stereotyping of Mexican Americans through information about others' perceptions and interaction* [Paper presentation]. American Sociological Association Virtual Conference.
- **Banks, J.** (June 2020). Project YUNG: A Demographically Appropriate Nutrition Curriculum. **Poster & oral** presentation at the 2020 Society for the Psychological Research of Social Issues Conference at Denver, Colorado. (Canceled due to COVID-19).
- Ruvalcaba, Y., & Eaton, A., Stephens, D., & **Banks, J.** (June 2020). Safety Strategies of Women who Experienced Homelessness: Community-based Participatory Research. **Talk** at the 2020 Society for the Psychological Research of Social Issues Conference at Denver, Colorado. (Canceled due to COVID-19).
- **Banks, J.**, & Sell, J. (October 2019). Expectation States Intervention for Stereotype Reduction in Diversity Training: An Experimental Method. **Poster & oral** presentation at the 2019 Southern Demography Association Conference at New Orleans, LA.
- **Banks, J.**, & Stephens, D., & Eaton, A. (October 2018). "I heard they do fun stuff here": Black Adolescent Girls' Perceptions of After School Programs in a Resource-Limited Neighborhood. **Poster & oral** presented at the Undergraduate McNair Conference at University of New Mexico, Albuquerque, MN.
- &September 2018). "I heard they do fun stuff here": Black Adolescent Girls' Perceptions of After School Programs in a Resource-Limited Neighborhood. **Poster** presented at the Undergraduate McNair Symposium, Miami, FL and Undergraduate McNair Conference at Baltimore County, MD.
- **Banks, J.**, Stephens, D., & Eaton, A. (October 2018). "I heard they do fun stuff here": Black Adolescent Girls' perceptions of After School programs in a resource-limited neighborhood. **Poster & oral** presented at the 2018 Undergraduate McNair Conference at University of New Mexico, Albuquerque, MN.

INVITED TALKS

- **November 2025** Zotero & Notion Research tool Introduction, Women of Color in the Arts, University of Michigan
- **October 2024** The Graduate School, Florida International University
- **August 2024** DISCO Summit, Majority World Digital Infrastructures with Lisa Nakamura, Marisa Duarte, Ivan Charr Lopez, Meryem Kamil, Huan He, and Jasmine Banks
- **February 2024** Stanford University — Guest Lecture
- **January 2024** University of Washington, School of Information
- **November 2023** SENSS: Southeast Network for Social Sciences
- **October 2023** Hampton University, Department of Psychology
- **July 2023** University of Michigan Summer Research Program for Undergraduates
- **November 2022** Media Psychology Lab, University of Michigan
- **July 2021** American Psychological Association — Division 45
- **July 2021** Pathways to Ph.D. Psychology Career — Invited Panelist

PRESENTATIONS AS MODERATOR/ORGANIZER

March 2025 Navigating Trust, Ethics, & Responsibility in the Era of Algorithms
University of Michigan Digital Studies Institute Research Colloquium

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2025–Present Society for the Study of Social Sciences
2023–Present National Communication Association
2022–Present The Association of Internet Researchers
2022–Present Psychology of Women – Division 35
2022–Present Society for the Psychological Study of Culture, Ethnicity, and Race – Division 45
2022–Present Society for Media Psychology and Technology – Division 46
2021–Present American Psychological Association
2021–Present American Sociological Association
2019–Present Society for the Psychological Research of Social Issues – Division 9
2019 Society for the Advancement of Chicanos/Hispanics and Native Americans in Science
2018 Society of Personality and Social Psychology

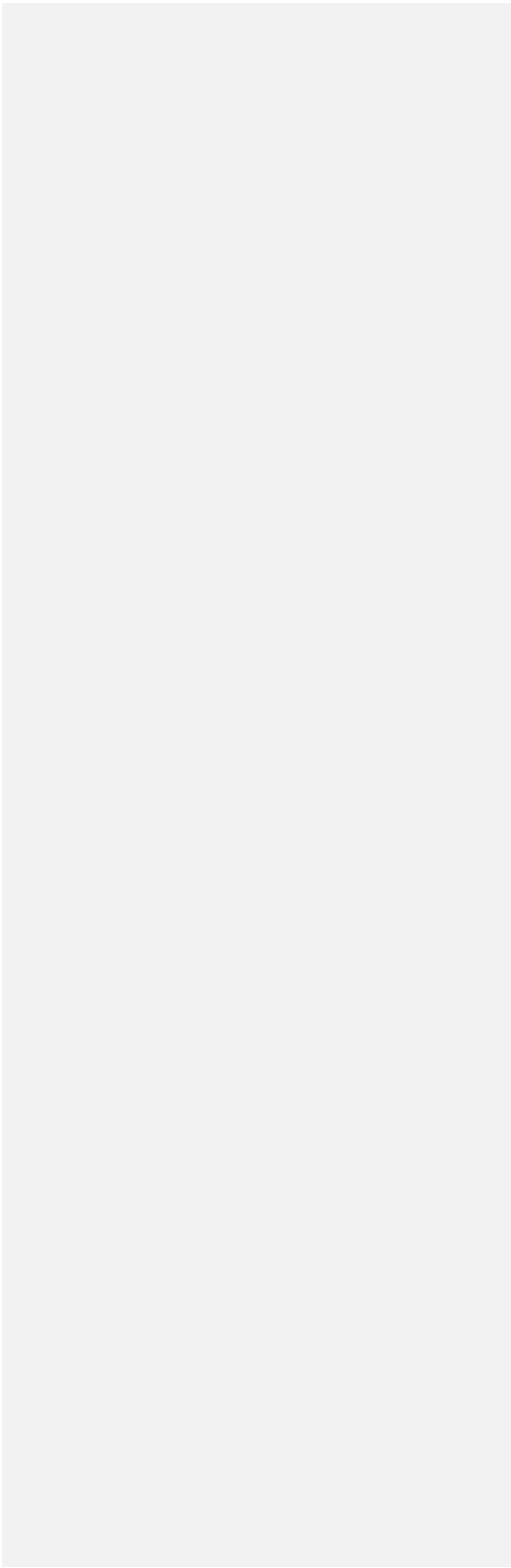
AD-HOC REVIEWER

2026-present Social Issues
2025 Cultural Diversity and Ethnic Minority Psychology
2025 Archives of Sexual Behavior
2024–Present International Communications Association Conference Reviewer
2024–Present New Media & Society
2023 Psychology of Women Quarterly
2023 Social and Personality Psychology

SERVICE

2024–Present Digital Studies Institute Graduate Coordinator

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REFERENCES

Isis Settles, Ph.D.

Professor

Psychology; Afroamerican and African
Studies; Women & Gender Studies

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